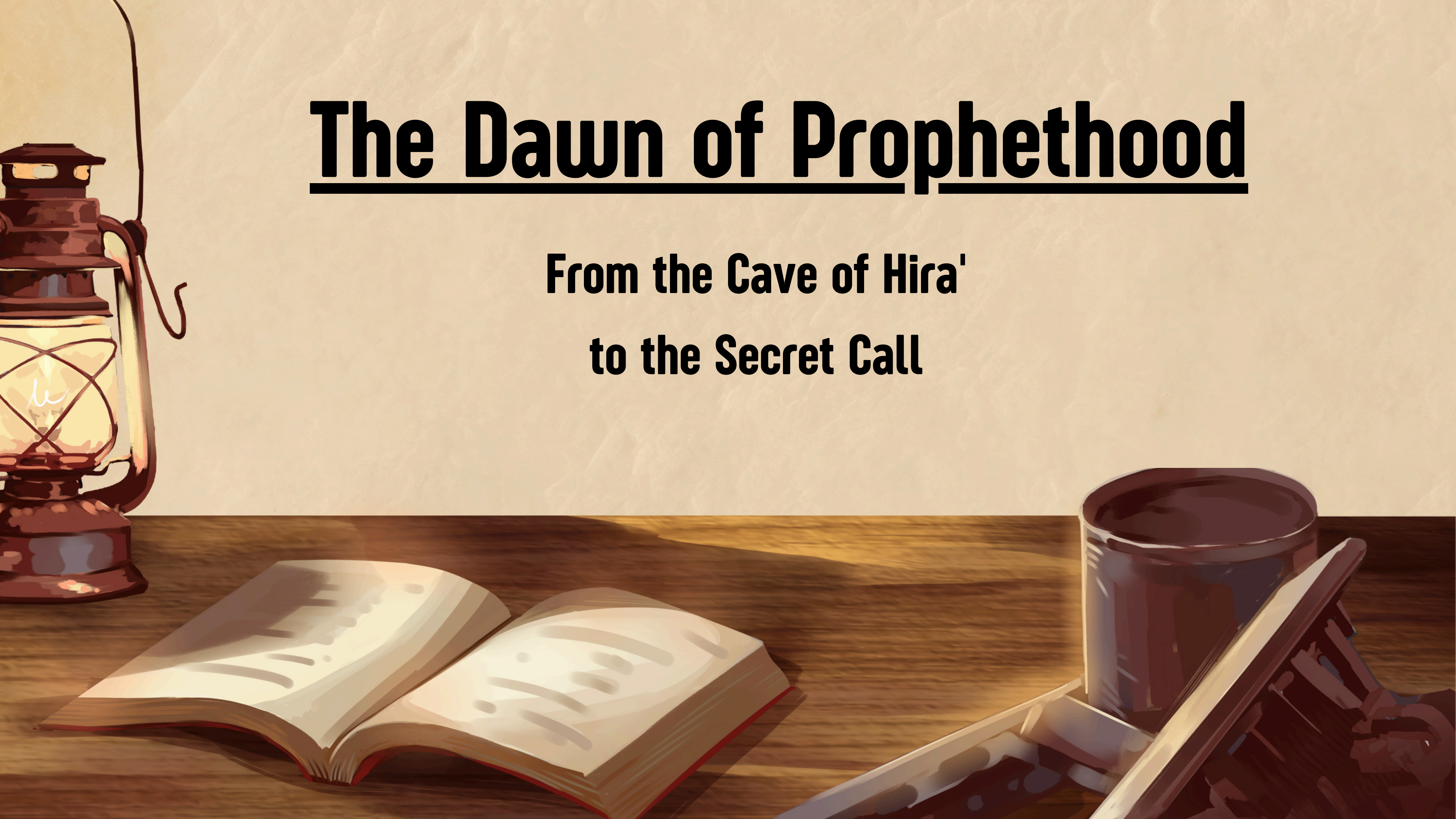


The Dawn of Prophethood

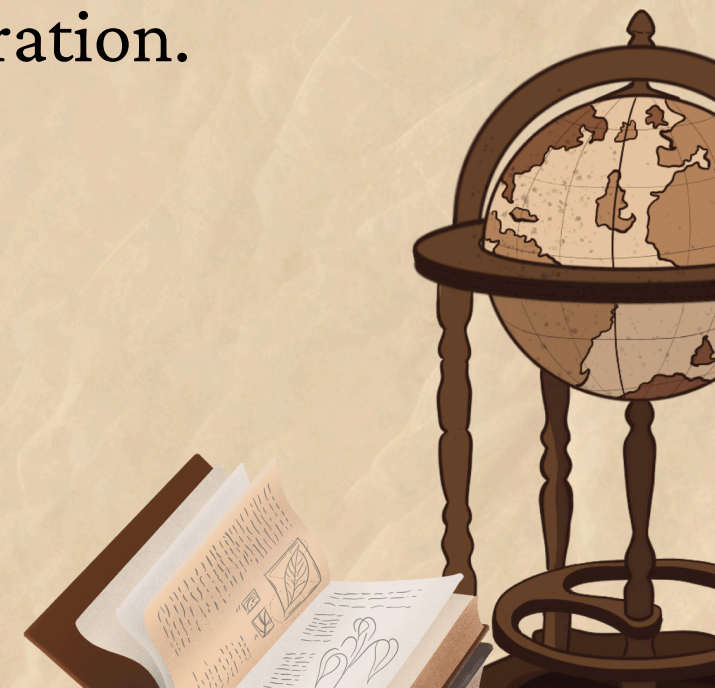
**From the Cave of Hira'
to the Secret Call**





Timeline of the Prophetic Mission

- **The Two Eras:** The life of the Prophet ﷺ after receiving his Message is divided into the Makkan Period (approx. 13 years) and the Madinian Period (approx. 10 years).
- **Stages of the Makkan Period:**
 - Secret Invitation: Lasted for three years.
 - Public Invitation: Focused on the people of Makkah from the 4th year until the Migration.
 - Expansion: Invitation to those outside Makkah beginning in the 10th year





Seclusion in the Cave of Hira'

- **A Habit of Reflection:** As the Prophet ﷺ approached age forty, he spent long hours in meditation and worship in a small cave named Hira' on Mount An-Noor.
- **Spiritual Preparation:** This period of privacy served as a divine preparation to carry the "great trust" and alter the course of history.
- **Early Signs:** Before the official Revelation, the Prophet ﷺ experienced "true dreams" that would manifest as clearly as the dawn.





The First Revelation

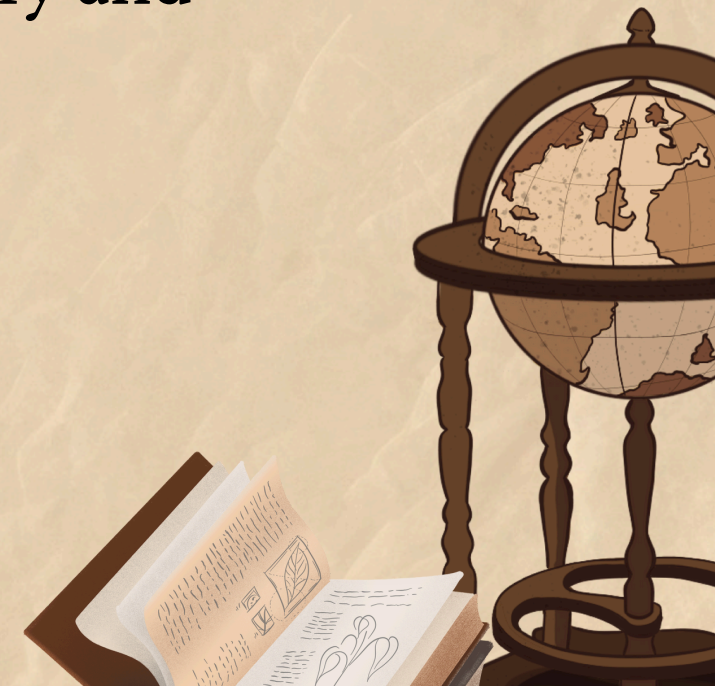
- **The Historical Date:** Research suggests the first Revelation occurred on Monday, the 21st of Ramadan (August 10, 610 C.E.).
- **The Encounter with Jibreel:** While in the cave, the Angel Jibreel appeared and commanded the Prophet ﷺ to "Recite".
- **The Command:** After the Prophet ﷺ replied that he could not recite, the first verses of Surah Al-Alaq were revealed: "Read! In the Name of your Lord, Who has created..."
- **Seeking Reassurance:** Returning home in fear, the Prophet ﷺ was comforted by his wife Khadijah, who praised his character.
- **Waraqah bin Nawfal:** Khadijah's cousin identified the visitor as 'Namus' (the angel of secrets) and predicted that the Prophet's own people would eventually turn him out





The Resumption of Revelation

- **The Pause (Fatrah):** Revelation paused for a short period to relieve the Prophet's fear and increase his longing for the Divine message.
- **The Second Call:** While walking, the Prophet ﷺ saw Jibreel again, seated on a chair between the sky and the earth.
- **The Mission Defined:** Allâh revealed Surah Al-Muddathir, commanding him to "Arise and warn!" and to "Magnify your Lord!".
- **New Duties:** This stage established the responsibility of warning against idolatry and maintaining personal purity





The Three Years of Secret Call

- **Strategic Discretion:** To avoid immediate conflict with Makkah's religious elite, the Prophet ﷺ initially shared the message with those closest to him.
- **The First Believers:**
 - **Khadijah:** The first person to embrace Islam.
 - **Ali bin Abi Talib, Zaid bin Harithah, and Abu Bakr:** Among the very first to respond on the first day.
- **Growth through Networking:** Through Abu Bakr's influence, key figures like Uthman bin Affan and Abdur-Rahman bin Awf also converted.
- **Early Teachings:** The first revelations focused on purifying the soul and describing the realities of the Hereafter

